

SOCIAL STUDIES

"I ka wa ma mua ka wa ma"

The future is found in the past -Olelo Noeau

Areas of Concentration

6th grade-Ancient Civilizations-Egypt, Mesopotamia/Sumeria, Israel, India, and China

7th grade-Ancient American cultures to colonization of America to the American Civil War

8th grade-Westward expansion to Industrial Revolution to WWI to WWII; Korean Conflict; Vietnam War; to Human Rights.

What happens if I turn in an assignment late?

Work not completed and turned in by the assigned date is considered late. If a student is absent on the date work is due, the assignment within a week from absence. There will be no penalty in your homework grade for an assignment turned in late, as long as it is turned in. There will be a deduction in your Active Learning grade. However if you do not turn in an assignment your score will not be added into your grade. A late assignment is better than a missing assignment

Welcome to Social Studies! Our focus this school year will be learning and developing our skills as critical thinkers, readers, writers, speakers, and listeners. The development and mastery of these important skills not only is important to achieving success in all school subjects, building strong relationships with others, and attaining a flourishing career as an adult. Basically, the quality of life you experience now through adulthood will depend a lot on how well you read, write, and communicate with others.

How will I be graded this year?

AOW or Article Of the Week refers to a weekly writing response students will complete on their Google Drive account. The poem, story, or article will be given on Mondays. Your responses will be due on Friday. Your response should include: 1)Any part of the article you liked, disliked, or were confused about. 2)WHY did you like, dislike, or were confused about this part. 3)Length is not as important as the amount of details and explanations you write about. **5 points each or 15% of your grade.**

Classwork-Summaries or notes In order to show me that you understand the information you received in class, you may be asked to write a summary about the material. Sometimes, the summaries will be counted as a quiz. **4 points each assignment or 30% of your grade.**

Essays You will be given a grading rubric before the essays are given. When we begin a unit, you will be given an essential question for the essay. We will be working on our answers to the essential questions together.

Projects Projects start during 2nd quarter. Projects follow the same guidelines as the essays. **25 points or 30% of your grade** If a project is not turned in within a week of the deadline, an essay topic will be assigned.

Quizzes-5-10 points or 15% of your grade

Active Learning-2 points each class day or 10% of your grade. Participation is based on coming to class prepared-Macbook charged, learning materials prepared, assignments completed, ready for class discussions, being an attentive listener, and actively engaged in class.

What supplies will I need?

Besides your textbook, you will need pencils, a folder paper, and sometimes markers or crayons, and glue.

Classwork grading scale

4= exceeds expectations
3= meets expectations
2=emerging towards expectations
1=far below exp./incomplete

Office Hours

I am available during recesses (unless on duty), before or after school. Please make an appointment with me. I will respond within 24 hours of an email. I do not respond after 6:30 p.m. unless there is an emergency.

6th Grade Goal – Building Foundations

By the end of 6th grade, students will:

- Demonstrate an understanding of early human history, ancient civilizations, and how geography influences culture and settlement.
- Use maps, timelines, and primary sources to gather information and explain historical events.
- Begin making connections between past societies and the modern world.
- Express ideas about history in clear, organized written and oral formats.

7th Grade Goal – Expanding Perspectives

By the end of 7th grade, students will:

- Analyze major American civilizations and cultures across different regions, identifying political, social, and economic systems.
- Evaluate the causes and effects of key historical events using evidence from primary and secondary sources.
- Compare different perspectives on historical issues and explain how they influence interpretation.
- Strengthen research and presentation skills by using evidence to support historical claims.

8th Grade Goal – Critical Citizenship

By the end of 8th grade, students will:

- Demonstrate a deep understanding of U.S. history from the Westward Expansion to modern day human rights.
- Analyze how historical events, laws, and movements shape government, rights, and responsibilities in a democratic society.
- Synthesize information from multiple sources to form and defend reasoned arguments about historical and civic issues.
- Apply historical thinking skills to current events, recognizing patterns, causes, and consequences.